



MERGE 4 DESIGN LLC

ARCHITECTURE DEVELOPMENT CONSULTING

500 Delaware Ave., Suite 1 #1551,
Wilmington, DE 19899 · info@merge4design.com · 302 367 5726

PROFESSIONAL FEE PROPOSAL

1212 Lobdel Avenue — Attainable Homeownership Development

Wilmington, DE · Predevelopment Intelligence Services

01. Project Identification

Project Name	1212 Lobdel Avenue — Attainable Homeownership Development
Parcel ID	2605130241
Address	1212 Lobdel Avenue, Wilmington, DE (City of Wilmington limits)
Client / Owner	Wilmington Housing Authority (WHA)
Submitted By	Merge 4 Design LLC (M4D) · 500 Delaware Ave., Suite 1 #1551, Wilmington, DE 19899 · 302 367 5726 · merge4design.com
Date Submitted	April 23, 2026
M4D Project Number	M2_2026_013



02. Project Context

1212 Lobdel Avenue is a 1.39-acre cleared infill site within the City of Wilmington, zoned R-3 (One-Family Row Houses, Chapter 48). The site is targeted for 30 or more units of for-sale attainable homeownership under WHA's homeownership program, with a target sale price of \$200,000–\$235,000 per home at 80% AMI.

WHA has confirmed a preference for fee-simple individual lot ownership with standard deeds, the appropriate structure for first-time homebuyer FHA and conventional financing. M4D's predevelopment scope delivers the full analysis needed to bring WHA to an informed yield configuration and construction type decision within a four-week engagement.

03. Scope of Services & Fee

M4D proposes services in two tracks. Track A — Predevelopment Intelligence, is authorized as a standalone fixed-fee engagement and delivered within four weeks.

Track B — Architecture & Engineering, is proposed separately upon WHA's written selection of yield option and construction type.

WHA Program Note: Incorporated into Track A Scope

Unit width targets: WHA has requested that yield analysis prioritize 18 ft and 20 ft wide lot configurations across all yield options (Options B, A+FW12, and D). Both widths will be carried through the construction cost matrix and site plan yield study.

Rear attached garage with occupiable roof deck: WHA has requested inclusion of a rear attached garage typology with the garage roof deck programmed as occupiable outdoor space accessed directly from the second level living area. This adds a meaningful square footage premium and private outdoor amenity to each unit without increasing lot footprint and will be carried as a distinct line item in the construction type matrix.

Roofline variety study: WHA's baseline preference is a standard A-shaped gable roof. The 3D site yield study will present a full range of roofline profiles within the 35 ft R-3 height limit — gable, shed, hip, and flat/garden roof — with the flat garden roof option specifically targeted at or near the same ROM price point as the traditional gable. All roofline options will be carried across both 18 ft and 20 ft wide unit widths on a 2-story footprint.

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Item	Deliverable — Description	Format	Schedule	Fee
A1	Site Assessment — parcel confirmation, Chapter 48 R-3 zoning analysis, applicable code standards and overlays	Memo	Wk 1	\$3,330
A2	Yield Scenario Analysis — fee-simple lot configurations for 18 ft and 20 ft wide units across Options B, A+FW12, and D; regulatory envelope confirmation	Report + Plans	Wk 1	\$4,440
A3	Construction Type Matrix — four systems (CLT/SIP-Hybrid, Off-Site Modular, Stick-Build, Garage-Base/Garden Roof) across all yield options and both unit widths; per-unit cost and gap analysis; rear garage typology as discrete add-alternate	Matrix Report	Wk 1–2	\$1,480
A4	Sustainability Add-Alternate — geothermal HVAC (shared bore field), community solar PV aisle canopy, rainwater harvesting; PACE financing and virtual net metering applicability	Analysis Memo	Wk 2	\$1,110
A5	3D Site Yield Study & Visualization — massing studies for all yield options across 18 ft and 20 ft widths; full roofline profile study (gable, shed, hip, flat/garden roof) within 35 ft height limit; flat garden roof cost-parity analysis; solar access analysis; photorealistic perspectives	3D + Site Plan	Wk 2–3	\$1,980
A6	WHA Presentation Package — all yield options, unit widths, roofline profiles, construction cost matrix, sustainability options, subsidy gap analysis (PPTX + PDF)	Presentation	Wk 3–4	\$1,650
A7	Subsidy Gap & Grant Program Memo — Delaware Catalyst Fund, HOME, DSHA program fit; per-unit gap analysis by option	Memo	Wk 3	\$1,320
A8	Gate 0 ROM Lock — cost estimates reconciled and locked; ALDDDB entry initiated	Summary	Wk 4	\$925
TRACK A TOTAL — FIXED FEE			4 weeks	\$16,235



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3.2 Track B — Architecture & Engineering (Authorized Separately)

Fees below are based on the 36-unit baseline. Subconsultants (Civil, Structural, MEP) are not included; budget approximately 12% of construction cost.

Phase	Scope	Basis	Fee
B1	Schematic Design — selected yield option and unit width; roofline profiles; unit plan types; 3D visualizations; site plan	Lump Sum	\$11,700
B2	Design Development — system coordination; structural and panel coordination	Lump Sum	\$17,550
B3	Construction Documents — permit-ready stamped set	Lump Sum	\$35,100
B4	Permitting & AHJ Coordination — City of Wilmington permit submission; plan review response	Hourly NTE	\$5,250
B5	Construction Administration — site observation; RFI/submittal review; punch list	Hourly NTE	\$9,450
B6	Reimbursable Expenses (at cost)	Actual	~\$4,000
TRACK B SUBTOTAL		—	\$83,050

3.3 Combined Fee & Track A Credit

	Amount
Track A — Predevelopment Intelligence (Fixed Fee)	\$16,235
Track B — Architecture & Engineering	\$83,050
Track B — Reimbursable Expenses (estimated)	~\$4,000
COMBINED TOTAL — TRACKS A + B	~\$103,285
★ TRACK A FEE CREDIT — Upon WHA's written authorization of Track B (full design services through Construction Documents), M4D will credit the full Track A fee of \$16,235 against the Track B Phase B1 invoice.	(\$16,235)
NET TOTAL AFTER TRACK A CREDIT	~\$87,050



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04. Authorization — Track A

To authorize Track A services, execute this proposal and return a signed copy to M4D. A Professional Services Agreement (PSA M2_2026_013) will be issued upon receipt. Services commence within three (3) business days of executed PSA and receipt of retainer.

Track A Fixed Fee

\$16,235.00

Retainer (50% due upon authorization): \$8,117.50
Balance due upon delivery of final Track A deliverables.

Delivery: 4 weeks from written authorization

Governing agreement: M4D PSA

M2_2026_013

Payment by check (payable to Merge 4 Design LLC) or ACH — banking instructions provided separately upon execution.

AUTHORIZED BY — MERGE 4 DESIGN LLC

Trevor Knight, Dir. Business Development
Merge 4 Design LLC

Date: _____



David C. Ainsworth AIA, Principal-in-Charge
Aubyn Architecture LLC (AOR)

Date: 04/23/2026

AUTHORIZED BY — WILMINGTON HOUSING AUTHORITY

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

FLAG FOR LEGAL/FINANCIAL REVIEW: Confirm WHA procurement requirements (DBE/MBE thresholds, HUD Section 3, City of Wilmington local hiring provisions) before contract execution. This proposal does not constitute a contract. Professional legal review recommended prior to execution.